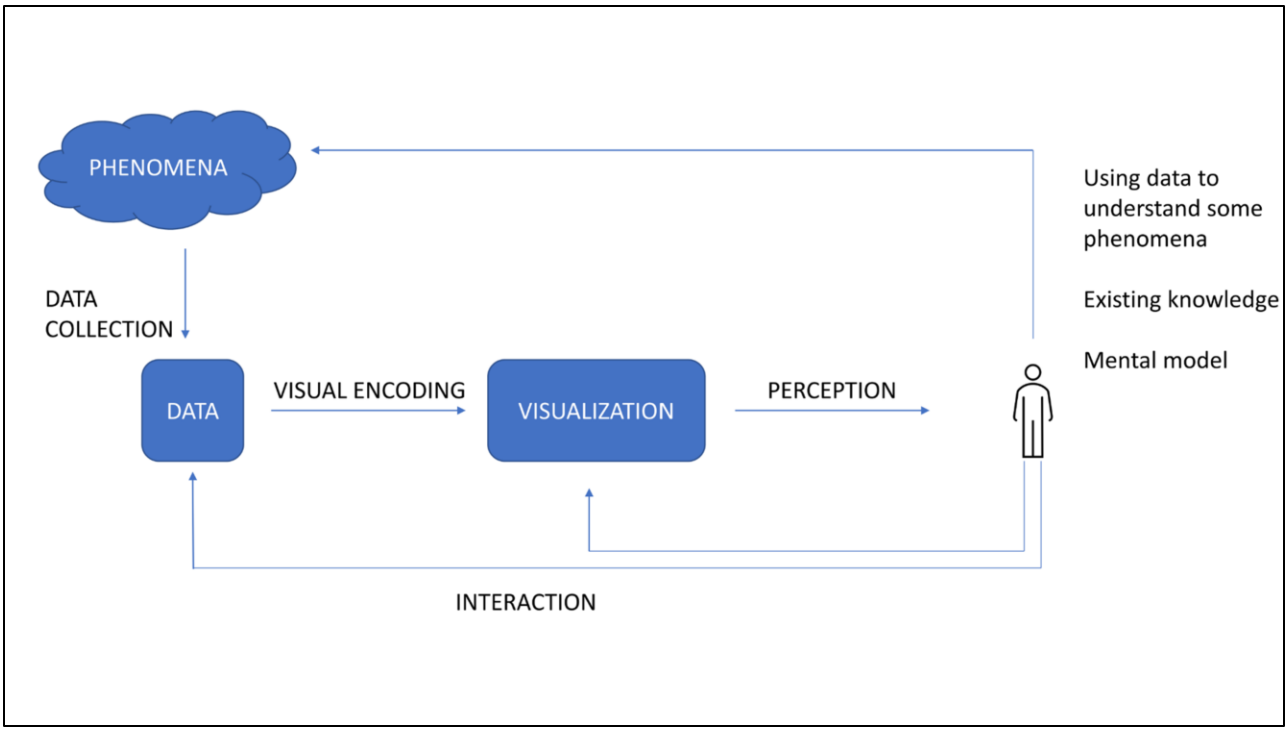
Characteristics of Good Insights

1. They bring deep understanding.
2. They are meaningful.
3. They are non-obvious.
4. Ideally, they are actionable.

- Good insight : something that is meaningful, insightful, and possibly actionable
- Data not on obvious data

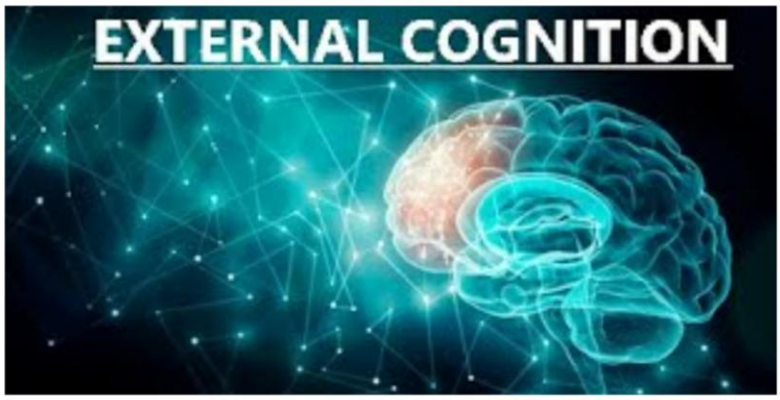

PHENOMENA
DATA COLLECTION
DATA
VISUAL ENCODING
VISUALIZATION
PERCEPTION
INTERACTION
Using data to understand some phenomena
Existing knowledge
Mental model

Byproducts of Good Data Visualization

1. People are able to make sense of complex phenomena.
2. Valuable knowledge is persisted.

Data visualization replaces external cognition with perception.

- Good visualization removes deep thinking to understand the data
- Help make sense of complex information
- Assist in understanding data instead of memorizing data



-external cognition is reduced
-visualizations distribute the storage of information
-mental bandwidth is freed for interpreting information encoded in visualization

What About the Other Senses?

-limited means of recording and displaying complex information in forms that focus exclusively on activating the other senses
-sight is a continuous experience that can immortalize a snapshot of information in time